



Hollow Knight

Hollow Knight is a 2017 Metroidvania video game developed and published by Australian independent developer Team Cherry. The player controls a nameless insectoid warrior exploring Hallownest, a fallen kingdom plagued by a supernatural disease. The game is set in diverse subterranean locations, featuring friendly and hostile insectoid characters and numerous bosses. Players have the opportunity to unlock abilities as they explore, along with pieces of lore and flavour text that are spread throughout the kingdom.

The concept behind *Hollow Knight* was conceived in 2013 in the Ludum Dare game jam. Adelaide-based Team Cherry wanted to create a game inspired by older platformers that replicated the explorational aspects of its influences. Inspirations for the game include *Faxanadu*, *Metroid*, *Zelda II: The Adventure of Link*, and *Mega Man X*.^[1] Development was partially funded through a Kickstarter crowdfunding campaign that raised over A\$57,000 by the end of 2014. It was released for Windows, Linux, and macOS in early 2017 and for the Nintendo Switch, PlayStation 4, and Xbox One in 2018. After release, Team Cherry supported the game with four free expansions as downloadable content.

Hollow Knight was well received by critics, with particular praise for its music, art style, worldbuilding, atmosphere, combat, and level of difficulty. It has since been regarded by some critics as one of the greatest games of all time.^[a] The game has sold more than 15 million copies. A sequel, *Hollow Knight: Silksong*, was released on 4 September 2025.

Gameplay

Hollow Knight is a 2D side-scrolling Metroidvania.^{[9][10]} The player controls a silent insectoid knight who explores an underground fallen

Hollow Knight



<u>Developer(s)</u>	Team Cherry
<u>Publisher(s)</u>	Team Cherry
<u>Designer(s)</u>	<u>Ari Gibson</u> <u>William Pellen</u>
<u>Programmer(s)</u>	William Pellen David Kazi
<u>Artist(s)</u>	Ari Gibson
<u>Composer(s)</u>	<u>Christopher Larkin</u>
<u>Engine</u>	<u>Unity</u>
<u>Platform(s)</u>	<u>Windows</u> <u>Linux</u> <u>macOS</u> <u>Nintendo Switch</u> <u>PlayStation 4</u> <u>Xbox One</u>
<u>Release</u>	Base game Windows 24 February 2017 Linux, macOS



Gameplay screenshot in which the player fights a boss enemy, the False Knight

kingdom called Hallownest. The player character can strike enemies with a sword-like weapon called a Nail and can learn spells that allow for long-range attacks.^{[10][11]}

The player starts with a limited number of hit points, which are represented by masks.^[12] By striking enemies, the player character gains Soul, which is stored in a "Soul Vessel". Initially, the player can only use Soul to "Focus" and regenerate masks, but as the game progresses, players unlock and collect several offensive spells, which consume Soul.^[13] If all masks are lost, the player dies, and a Shade enemy appears at the approximate location of the player's death. The player loses all Geo, the game's main currency, and can hold a reduced amount of Soul. Players must defeat the Shade enemy to recover lost Geo and carry the normal amount of Soul.^[12]

During the game, the player encounters bug-themed non-player characters (NPCs) with whom they can interact. These characters provide information about the plot, offer aid, and sell items or services.^[12] Players acquire items that provide movement abilities including an additional mid-air jump, adhering to and jumping off walls, or a quick dash. To further customise the Knight, players can equip various charms, which can be found or purchased from NPCs. Some of their effects include improved combat abilities, such as granting the player more range with the Nail, or allowing them to collect Soul more easily. Equipping a charm takes up a certain number of limited slots, called notches.^{[10][12]} Many areas feature challenging enemies and bosses which the player may need to defeat in order to progress.^[11] Defeating some bosses grants the player access to new abilities.^{[10][12]} If the player defeats the final boss, they are given access to a gamemode called "Steel Soul". In this mode, dying is permanent, i.e. if the player loses all of their masks, the save slot will be reset.^[14]

The Kingdom of Hallownest consists of several large, inter-connected areas with unique themes.^[10] With its nonlinear gameplay Metroidvania design, *Hollow Knight* does not restrict the player to one path nor require them to explore the whole world; there are places that can be missed when finishing the game, though there are obstacles that limit the player's access to various areas. The player may need to acquire a specific movement ability, skill, or item to progress further.^[12] To fast travel through the world, the player can use Stag Stations, terminals connected to a network of tunnels that are traversed via giant stag beetles; players can only travel to previously visited and unlocked stations.^{[11][15]}

11 April 2017

Nintendo Switch

12 June 2018

PlayStation 4, Xbox One

25 September 2018

Content packs

Hidden Dreams

3 August 2017

The Grimm Troupe

26 October 2017

Lifeblood

20 April 2018

Godmaster

23 August 2018

Genre(s)

Metroidvania

Mode(s)

Single-player

As the player enters a new area, they do not have access to the map of their surroundings. They must find Cornifer, the cartographer, to buy a rough map. As the player explores an area, the map becomes more accurate and complete if the Quill has been obtained, although it is updated only when sitting on a bench. The player will need to buy specific items to complete maps, to see points of interest, and to place markers. The player character's position on the map can only be seen if the player has the Wayward Compass charm equipped.^{[9][11]}

Plot

At the outset, the player-controlled insectoid warrior arrives in Dirtmouth, a quiet town that sits just above the remains of the kingdom of Hallownest. As the protagonist ventures through the ruins, they learn that Hallownest was once a flourishing kingdom of insects which fell after becoming overrun with "The Infection", a supernatural disease that can infect anyone by entering the subject's dreams and controlling their minds and wills. The Infection gives its subjects heightened strength but at the cost of their civility, causing madness and undeath. Hallownest's ruler, The Pale King, had previously attempted to lock away the Infection in the Temple of the Black Egg. Despite the temple's magical seals, the disease managed to escape, and Hallownest fell into ruin. The protagonist's mission is to find and kill three bugs called the Dreamers, who act as the living seals on the temple door. Once the seals have been removed, the player may confront the source of the Infection. This quest brings the player into conflict with Hornet, a warrior who tests their combat prowess in several battles.

Through dialogue with non-player characters, environmental imagery, and writings scattered throughout Hallownest, the protagonist learns the origins of the Infection. In ancient times, a tribe of moths that lived in Hallownest worshipped the Radiance, a primordial being who could control the minds of other bugs. When the Pale King arrived at Hallownest from afar, he used his powers to give sapience and knowledge to the creatures of the realm. The moths soon joined the other bugs of Hallownest in worshipping the Pale King, draining the power of the Radiance as she was slowly forgotten. Beneath the notice of the Pale King, some worship of the Radiance continued, allowing her to remain alive inside the Dream Realm.^[16]

Hallownest prospered until the Radiance began appearing in the dreams of its people, poisoning their minds with the Infection. In an attempt to contain the menace, the Pale King used an ancient power called Void to create the Vessels – creatures that could trap the Infection within their own bodies. Due to the Vessels being made from Void, they are considered to not have free will, thus allowing them to not be infected since they cannot dream. The Pale King chose a Vessel known as the Hollow Knight to trap the Radiance, leaving the rest locked in a pit called the Abyss. After the Hollow Knight was locked within the Temple of the Black Egg, the Radiance persisted within the Vessel, weakening the temple's seals and allowing the Infection to escape.

Throughout the game, it is revealed that the protagonist was a Vessel who managed to escape the Abyss. They gradually defeat the Dreamers and their guardians, removing the seals on the door. Inside, they encounter and battle with the infected Hollow Knight. Depending on the player's actions, three endings can then be achieved:

- If the protagonist defeats the infected Hollow Knight alone, they take the infected Hollow Knight's place, sealing the infection within their own body and then sealing themselves in the Temple of the Black Egg.

- If the protagonist defeats the infected Hollow Knight with Hornet's assistance, the protagonist seals themselves, the infection, and Hornet inside the Temple of the Black Egg, with the seal bearing an image of Hornet's face.
- If the protagonist has the Void Heart and uses it to confront the Radiance, then the protagonist calls upon the power of the Void to destroy the Radiance once and for all. Hornet then awakens to find both the protagonist and the Temple of the Black Egg have disappeared, leaving nothing behind except the protagonist's broken mask.

The Grimm Troupe expansion

In the second expansion to *Hollow Knight*, a "Nightmare Lantern" was added to the Howling Cliffs area. After striking a masked bug with the Dream Nail, the lantern summons a mysterious group of circus performers to Dirtmouth, who identify themselves as the Grimm Troupe. Their leader, Troupe Master Grimm, gives the player a quest to collect magic flames throughout Hallownest in order to take part in a "twisted ritual". He gives the player the Grimmchild charm, which absorbs the flames into itself, progressing the ritual and allowing the Grimmchild to attack the player's enemies. Eventually, the player must choose to either complete the ritual by fighting Grimm in his powerful Nightmare King form, or prevent the ritual and banish the Grimm Troupe with the help of Brumm in the Howling Cliffs, a traitorous troupe member.^[17]

Godmaster expansion

More content was added to *Hollow Knight* with the fourth and final expansion, *Godmaster*, in which the player can battle harder versions of all of the bosses through a series of challenges. The main hub of the expansion is known as Godhome. Within Godhome are five "pantheons", each being a "boss rush", containing a set of bosses that must all be defeated consecutively without dying. The final pantheon, the Pantheon of Hallownest, contains every boss in the game or alternate forms of original bosses. If the player completes the Pantheon of Hallownest, the Absolute Radiance, a more powerful version of the Radiance, appears, acting as the new final boss. Upon defeating it, two unique endings can be achieved, each involving the destruction of Godhome by a powerful Void entity.

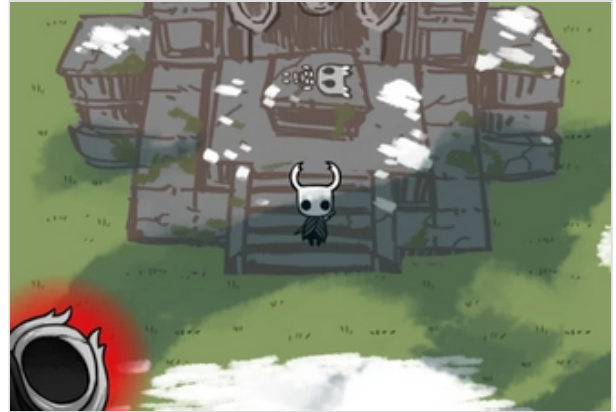
Development

The idea that prompted the creation of *Hollow Knight* originated in a game jam, *Ludum Dare* 2013, in which two of the game's developers, *Ari Gibson* and *William Pellen*, developed a game called *Hungry Knight*, whose main character's design eventually became the protagonist in *Hollow Knight*, kills bugs to stave off starvation.^[18] The game, considered "not very good", used to hold a 1/5 star rating on *Newgrounds*, but has since increased to 4/5.^{[18][19]} The developers decided to work on another game jam with the theme "Beneath the Surface", but missed the deadline. However, the concept gave them the idea to create a game with an underground setting, a "deep, old kingdom", and insect characters.^{[18][20]}

Influences for the game include *Faxanadu*, *Dark Souls*, *Metroid*, *Zelda II: The Adventure of Link*, and *Mega Man X*. Team Cherry noted that Hallownest was in some ways the inverse of the world tree setting in *Faxanadu*. The team wanted to replicate the sense of wonder and discovery of games from their childhood from such games, in which there "could be any crazy secret or weird creature."^{[21][22]} Believing that control of the character was most important for the player's enjoyment of the game, the developers based the player's movement on *Mega Man X*. They gave the character no acceleration when

moving horizontally, as well as a large amount of aerial control and the ability to interrupt one's jump with a dash.^[18] This was meant to make the player feel that any hit they took could have been avoided right up until the last second.^[18]

To create the game's art, Gibson's hand-drawn sketches were scanned directly into the game engine, creating a "vivid sense of place". The developers decided to "keep it simple" in order to prevent the development time from becoming extremely protracted.^[18] The complexity of the world was based on *Metroid*, which allows players to become disoriented and lost, focusing on the enjoyment of finding one's way. Only basic signs are placed throughout the world to direct players to important locations.^[18] The largest design challenge was creating the mapping system and finding a balance between not divulging the world's secrets while not being too player-unfriendly.^[18]



Gameplay screenshot of *Hungry Knight*, featuring the first appearance of *Hollow Knight*'s protagonist

Hollow Knight was revealed on Kickstarter in November 2014, with a goal of A\$35,000. The game passed this goal, raising more than A\$57,000 from 2,158 backers, allowing its scope to be expanded and another developer to be hired—technical director David Kazi—as well as composer Christopher Larkin.^[18]

The game reached a beta state in September 2015 and continued to achieve numerous stretch goals to add in more content after an engine switch from Stencyl to Unity.^[23]

Release

Hollow Knight was released for Windows on 24 February 2017, with versions for Linux and macOS being released on 11 April of the same year.^[24]

The Nintendo Switch version of *Hollow Knight* was announced in January 2017 and released on 12 June 2018. Team Cherry originally planned to make it available on the Wii U. Development of the Wii U version began in 2016, alongside the PC version, and it eventually shifted to the Nintendo Switch following the Wii U's discontinuation.^[25] The creators of *Hollow Knight* worked with another Australian developer, Shark Jump Studios, to speed up the porting process.^[26] Initially, Team Cherry planned the Switch version to arrive "not too long after the platform's launch"; subsequently they delayed it to early 2018.^[27] A release date was not announced until the Nintendo Direct presentation at E3 2018 on 12 June 2018, when it was unveiled the game would be available later that day via Nintendo eShop.^[28]

Versions for PlayStation 4 and Xbox One were released as *Hollow Knight: Voidheart Edition* on 25 September 2018.^[29]

A *Hollow Knight Piano Collections* sheet music book and album was released in 2019 by video game music label Materia Collective, arranged by David Peacock and performed by Augustine Mayuga Gonzales.^[30]

Downloadable content

On 3 August 2017, the *Hidden Dreams* free downloadable content (DLC) was released, featuring two optional boss encounters, two songs in the soundtrack, a fast travel system, and a Stag Station to discover.^[31] On 26 October 2017, the second free DLC *The Grimm Troupe* was released, adding major quests, boss fights, charms, enemies, and other content. The update added support for Russian, Portuguese, and Japanese languages.^[32] On 20 April 2018, the *Lifeblood* free update was released, bringing various optimisations, changes to the colour palette, bug fixes, minor additions as well as a new boss fight.^[33] On 23 August 2018, the final free DLC, *Godmaster* was released, containing characters, boss fights, music, a game mode called Godseeker as well as two endings.^[34] It was renamed from its former title of *Gods and Glory* due to trademark concerns.^[35] All four DLC packs are free.

Reception

Reception	
Aggregate scores	
Aggregator	Score
<u>Metacritic</u>	PC: 87/100 ^[36] NS: 90/100^[37] PS4: 85/100 ^[38] XONE: 89/100^[39]
<u>OpenCritic</u>	99% recommend ^[40]
Review scores	
Publication	Score
<u>Destructoid</u>	10/10 ^[11]
<u>Eurogamer</u>	Recommended ^[41]
<u>IGN</u>	9.4/10 ^[42]
<u>Nintendo Life</u>	9/10 ^[43]
<i>Nintendo World Report</i>	10/10 ^[44]
<u>PC Gamer (US)</u>	92/100 ^[10]
<u>PC PowerPlay</u>	8/10 ^[45]
<i>VideoGamer.com</i>	8/10 ^[46]

Hollow Knight's PC, PlayStation 4, and Xbox One versions received "generally favorable" reviews and the Nintendo Switch version received "universal acclaim", according to review aggregator website Metacritic.^{[36][37][39]} OpenCritic determined that 99% of critics recommended the game.^[40] Jed Whitaker of *Destructoid* praised it as a "masterpiece of gaming"^[11] and, on *PC Gamer*, Tom Marks called it a "new classic".^[10] *IGN* praised *Hollow Knight*'s visuals, sound, music, and "a million other details" in building atmosphere.^[42]

Critics recognised the combat system as simple^{[41][42]} and nuanced;^[45] they praised its responsiveness, or "tightness", similarly to the movement system.^{[11][43][44][45][46]} On *IGN*, Marks stated: "The combat in *Hollow Knight* is relatively straightforward, but starts out tricky ... It rewards patience and skill

massively".^[42] In his review on *PC Gamer*, Marks praised the "brilliant" charm system: "What's so impressive about these charms is that I could never find a 'right' answer when equipping them. There were no wrong choices."^[10] Adam Abou-Nasr from *NintendoWorldReport* stated: "Charms offer a huge variety of upgrades ... removing them felt like trading a part of myself for a better chance at an upcoming battle."^[44]

The difficulty of *Hollow Knight* received attention from reviewers and was described as challenging;^{[42][43][45]} Vikki Blake of *Eurogamer* called the game "ruthlessly tough, even occasionally unfair".^[41] For *Nintendo World Report*'s Adam Abou-Nasr it also seemed unfair—he had "'so frustratingly hard that I cannot recommend this game' angrily scrawled in [his] notes"—but "it eventually clicked".^[44] Whitaker "never found any of the bosses to be unfair".^[11] *Destructoid* and *Nintendo World Report* reviewers felt a sense of accomplishment after difficult fights.^{[11][44]} Critics also made comparisons to the *Dark Souls* series, noting the mechanic of losing currency on death and having to defeat a Shade to regain it.^{[11][43][45]} *Destructoid* praised this feature, as well as the holding down of a button to heal, because "[t]hey circumvent a couple of issues games have always had, namely appropriate punishment for failing, and a risk-reward system".^[11]



Cosplay of Hornet and the protagonist

Sales

Hollow Knight had sold over 500,000 copies by November 2017 and surpassed 1 million in sales on PC platforms on 11 June 2018, one day before being released on Nintendo Switch, where it sold over 250,000 copies in the two weeks after its launch.^{[47][48][49]} By July 2018 it had sold over 1.2 million copies.^[48] By February 2019, *Hollow Knight* had sold over 2.8 million copies.^{[50][51]} As of August 2025, it had sold more than 15 million copies.^[52]

Awards

The game was nominated for "Best PC Game" in *Destructoid*'s Game of the Year Awards 2017,^[53] and for "Best Platformer" in *IGN*'s Best of 2017 Awards.^[54] It won the award for "Best Platformer" in *PC Gamer*'s 2017 Game of the Year Awards.^[55] *Polygon* later named the game among the decade's best.^[56]

Year	Award	Category	Result	Ref.
2017	<u>SXSW Gamer's Voice Awards 2017</u>	Gamer's Voice (Single Player)	Nominated	[57]
	<u>The Game Awards 2017</u>	Best Debut Indie Game	Nominated	[58]
	<u>Australian Screen Sound Guild 2017</u>	Best Sound For Interactive Media	Won	[59]
2018	<u>Game Developers Choice Awards</u>	Best Debut (Team Cherry)	Nominated	[60][61]
	<u>14th British Academy Games Awards</u>	Debut Game	Nominated	[62][63]
	<u>Golden Joystick Awards</u>	Nintendo Game of the Year	Nominated	[64][65]
	Australian Games Awards	Independent Game of the Year	Won	[66]
		Australian Developed Game of the Year	Won	
2019	National Academy of Video Game Trade Reviewers Awards	Art Direction, Fantasy	Nominated	[67][68]
		Character Design	Nominated	
		Design, New IP	Won	
		Game, Original Action	Nominated	

Sequel

A sequel, *Hollow Knight: Silksong*, was developed by Team Cherry and released on Windows, macOS, Linux, Nintendo Switch, Nintendo Switch 2, PlayStation 4, PlayStation 5,^[69] and Xbox Series X/S, on 4 September 2025.

The sequel set after the events of the original game revolves around the character Hornet exploring the kingdom of Pharloom.^[70] Game demos of *Hollow Knight: Silksong* demonstrate similar combat styles to the original game, but with several gameplay differences. The player character Hornet is more mobile than *Hollow Knight*'s protagonist, and Charms are replaced with the more elaborate Tool and Crest system.^{[71][72]} Team Cherry had previously planned this game as a DLC for its predecessor, but decided to market it an individual title as its content grew too large.^[73] It was announced in February 2019.

Notes

a. As cited by: IGN,^[2] Rolling Stone,^[3] GQ,^[4] USA Today,^[5] Sports Illustrated,^[6] The Independent,^[7] and GamingBolt.^[8]

References

1. "Straight from the Source: Ari Gibson & William Pellen (Team Cherry)" (<https://sourcegaming.info/2025/04/09/straight-from-the-source-team-cherry/>). *Source Gaming*. 9 April 2025. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250603130042/https://sourcegaming.info/2025/04/09/straight-from-the-source-team-cherry/>) from the original on 3 June 2025. Retrieved 9 June 2025.

2. "The Top 100 Video Games of All Time" (<https://www.ign.com/articles/the-best-100-video-games-of-all-time>). *IGN*. 31 December 2021. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211231162533/https://www.ign.com/articles/the-best-100-video-games-of-all-time>) from the original on 31 December 2021. Retrieved 31 December 2021.
3. "The 50 Greatest Video Games of All Time" (<https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/rs-gaming-lists/best-video-games-of-all-time-1235215978/>). *Rolling Stone*. 6 January 2025. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250106220137/https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/rs-gaming-lists/best-video-games-of-all-time-1235215978/>) from the original on 6 January 2025. Retrieved 7 January 2025.
4. "The 100 greatest video games of all time, ranked by experts" (<https://www.gq-magazine.co.uk/article/best-video-games-all-time>). *GQ*. 10 May 2023. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230510142624/https://www.gq-magazine.co.uk/article/best-video-games-all-time>) from the original on 10 May 2023. Retrieved 11 May 2023.
5. Cosolo, Tony (26 January 2024). "A definitive ranking of the top 30 video games of all time" (<https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games-all-time-list-zelda-mario>). *USA Today*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20240128103906/https://ftw.usatoday.com/lists/best-video-games-all-time-list-zelda-mario>) from the original on 28 January 2024. Retrieved 3 February 2024.
6. GLHF (27 January 2023). "The best 100 games of all time, ranked" (<https://videogames.si.com/guides/best-games>). *Sports Illustrated*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230129174343/https://videogames.si.com/guides/best-games>) from the original on 29 January 2023. Retrieved 29 January 2023.
7. Brigstock, Jake; Fletcher, Harry (28 February 2025). "The best 100 video games of all time" (<https://www.indy100.com/gaming/best-video-games-ever-all-time-100-81>). *indy100*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250301043902/https://www.indy100.com/gaming/best-video-games-ever-all-time-100-81>) from the original on 1 March 2025. Retrieved 3 March 2025.
8. "Top 30 Video Games of All Time" (<https://gamingbolt.com/top-30-video-games-of-all-time>). *GamingBolt*. 11 April 2022. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220411083601/https://gamingbolt.com/top-30-video-games-of-all-time>) from the original on 11 April 2022. Retrieved 12 April 2022.
9. Walker, John (2 March 2017). "Hollow Knight feels too familiar, despite being a solid metroidvania" (<https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/2017/03/02/hollow-knight-review/>). *rockpapershotgun*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170812094620/https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/2017/03/02/hollow-knight-review/>) from the original on 12 August 2017. Retrieved 28 May 2022.
10. Marks, Tom (10 July 2017). "Hollow Knight review" (<https://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knight-review/>). *PC Gamer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170713025733/http://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knight-review/>) from the original on 13 July 2017. Retrieved 10 July 2017.
11. Whitaker, Jed (27 March 2017). "Review: Hollow Knight" (<https://www.destructoid.com/review-w-hollow-knight-427608.phtml>). *Destructoid*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170327223357/https://www.destructoid.com/review-hollow-knight-427608.phtml>) from the original on 27 March 2017. Retrieved 27 March 2017.
12. *Hollow Knight Game Manual*. Team Cherry. 2017.
13. Venter, Jason (20 July 2018). "Hollow Knight beginner's guide" (<https://www.polygon.com/guides/2018/7/20/17581234/hollow-knight-beginners-guide-map-pins-quill-charms-rancid-egg-switch>). *Polygon*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220217002526/https://www.polygon.com/guides/2018/7/20/17581234/hollow-knight-beginners-guide-map-pins-quill-charms-rancid-egg-switch>) from the original on 17 February 2022. Retrieved 16 February 2022.

14. Rochlin, Jason (25 September 2021). "Hollow Knight: Silksong Should Take Steel Soul Mode to the Next Level With Silk Soul" (<https://gamerant.com/hollow-knight-silksong-steel-silk-soul-challenge-navigation-combat/>). *Game Rant*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220217002527/https://gamerant.com/hollow-knight-silksong-steel-silk-soul-challenge-navigation-combat/>) from the original on 17 February 2022. Retrieved 16 February 2022.
15. Horti, Samuel (5 August 2017). "Hollow Knight's free Hidden Dreams update out now" (<http://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knights-free-hidden-dreams-update-out-now/>). *PC Gamer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171021110535/https://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knights-free-hidden-dreams-update-out-now/>) from the original on 21 October 2017. Retrieved 28 May 2022.
16. Team Cherry (3 March 2017) *Hollow Knight*. "**Seer**: But the memories of that ancient light still lingered, hush whispers of faith... Until all of Hallownest began to dream of that forgotten light. (Seer NPC talking to Knight)"
17. "The Grimm Troupe Descends!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190427062004/http://teamcherry.com.au/the-grimm-troupe/>). *Team Cherry Blog*. 14 September 2017. Archived from the original (<https://teamcherry.com.au/the-grimm-troupe/>) on 27 April 2019. Retrieved 28 May 2022.
18. Milner, David. "The Making Of Hollow Knight" (<https://www.gameinformer.com/2018/10/15/the-making-of-hollow-knight>). *Game Informer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200406144654/https://www.gameinformer.com/2018/10/16/the-making-of-hollow-knight>) from the original on 6 April 2020. Retrieved 4 March 2020.
19. Pellen, William (2 August 2014). "Hungry Knight!" (<https://www.newgrounds.com/portal/view/643636>). *Newgrounds*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210127231806/https://www.newgrounds.com/portal/view/643636>) from the original on 27 January 2021. Retrieved 23 February 2021.
20. Warr, Philippa (30 September 2015). "State of the Art: The Elegiac Beauty Of Hollow Knight" (<https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/hollow-knight-concept-art>). *Rock Paper Shotgun*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220422050306/https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/hollow-knight-concept-art>) from the original on 22 April 2022. Retrieved 25 May 2022.
21. Hamilton, Kirk (2 September 2018). "The Makers of Hollow Knight Are Fine with Players Missing Things" (<https://kotaku.com/the-makers-of-hollow-knight-are-fine-with-players-missing-things-1828721254>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190129181719/https://kotaku.com/the-makers-of-hollow-knight-are-fine-with-players-missing-things-1828721254>) from the original on 29 January 2019. Retrieved 29 January 2019.
22. "Kotaku Splitscreen" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190129182227/https://player.megaphone.fm/PPY3701296316>). *Kotaku*. Archived from the original (<https://player.megaphone.fm/PPY3701296316>) on 29 January 2019. Retrieved 29 January 2019.
23. "Team Cherry is Back! New Year, New Office, New Team Mate, New Engine!" (<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/11662585/hollow-knight/posts/1120881>). *Kickstarter*. 30 January 2015. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190730203224/https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/11662585/hollow-knight/posts/1120881>) from the original on 30 July 2019. Retrieved 30 July 2019.
24. "Hollow Knight Mac Debut Delay" (<https://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-mac-debut-delay/>). 22 February 2017. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170823165620/http://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-mac-debut-delay/>) from the original on 23 August 2017. Retrieved 23 August 2017.
25. Cousins, Jon (21 January 2018). "Feature: Bugging Out With Hollow Knight's Team Cherry" (https://www.nintendolife.com/news/2018/01/feature_bugging_out_with_hollow_knights_team_cherry). *Nintendo Life*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180627005631/http://www.nintendolife.com/news/2018/01/feature_bugging_out_with_hollow_knights_team_cherry) from the original on 27 June 2018. Retrieved 26 June 2018.

26. Devore, Jordan (17 May 2017). "Hollow Knight now has a second team to help speed up the Switch port" (<https://www.destructoid.com/hollow-knight-now-has-a-second-team-to-help-speed-up-the-switch-port-436648.phtml>). *Destructoid*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190403015317/https://www.destructoid.com/hollow-knight-now-has-a-second-team-to-help-speed-up-the-switch-port-436648.phtml>) from the original on 3 April 2019. Retrieved 26 June 2018.
27. Wales, Matt (14 November 2018). "Hollow Knight on Switch has been delayed until early next year" (<https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2017-11-14-hollow-knight-on-switch-has-been-delayed-until-early-next-year>). *Eurogamer.net*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180627011006/https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2017-11-14-hollow-knight-on-switch-has-been-delayed-until-early-next-year>) from the original on 27 June 2018. Retrieved 26 June 2018.
28. Wales, Matt (12 June 2018). "Hollow Knight is out on Switch today" (<https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2018-06-12-hollow-knight-is-out-today-on-switch>). *Eurogamer.net*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180612233913/https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2018-06-12-hollow-knight-is-out-today-on-switch>) from the original on 12 June 2018. Retrieved 26 June 2018.
29. Vincent, Brittany (11 September 2018). "Hollow Knight: Voidheart Edition brings the action to PS4 and Xbox One this month" (<https://www.shacknews.com/article/107201/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition-brings-the-action-to-ps4-and-xbox-one-this-month>). *Shacknews*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20201031095313/https://www.shacknews.com/article/107201/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition-brings-the-action-to-ps4-and-xbox-one-this-month>) from the original on 31 October 2020. Retrieved 10 April 2022.
30. Moyse, Chris (26 November 2019). "Haunting Hollow Knight Piano Collection soundtrack launches this week" (<https://www.destructoid.com/haunting-hollow-knight-piano-collection-soundtrack-launches-this-week/>). *Destructoid*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220227034249/https://www.destructoid.com/haunting-hollow-knight-piano-collection-soundtrack-launches-this-week/>) from the original on 27 February 2022. Retrieved 27 February 2022.
31. Warr, Philippa (4 August 2017). "Hidden Dreams free DLC now in Hollow Knight" (<https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/2017/08/04/hollow-knight-hidden-dreams/>). *Rock Paper Shotgun*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200304105240/https://www.rockpapershotgun.com/2017/08/04/hollow-knight-hidden-dreams/>) from the original on 4 March 2020. Retrieved 4 March 2020.
32. "The Grimm Troupe Descends! Backer Rewards! TGS! Cosplay! More!" (<https://teamcherry.com.au/the-grimm-troupe/>). *Team Cherry*. 14 September 2017. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171027025040/http://teamcherry.com.au/the-grimm-troupe/>) from the original on 27 October 2017. Retrieved 26 October 2017.
33. "Hollow Knight: Lifeblood has launched!" (<https://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-lifblood-has-launched/>). *Team Cherry*. 20 April 2018. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180527075728/http://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-lifblood-has-launched/>) from the original on 27 May 2018. Retrieved 31 May 2018.
34. "Gods & Glory Revealed! Christmas Wrap! Switchy-stuff!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180216143812/http://teamcherry.com.au/godsglory/>). *Team Cherry*. 31 January 2018. Archived from the original (<https://teamcherry.com.au/godsglory/>) on 16 February 2018. Retrieved 16 February 2018.
35. "Hollow Knight: Gods & Glory is now Godmaster!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180907135304/http://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-gods-glory-is-now-godmaster/>). *Team Cherry*. 15 August 2018. Archived from the original (<https://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-gods-glory-is-now-godmaster/>) on 7 September 2018. Retrieved 9 September 2018.
36. "Hollow Knight for PC Reviews" (<https://www.metacritic.com/game/hollow-knight/critic-reviews/?platform=pc>). *Metacritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170630192438/http://www.metacritic.com/game/pc/hollow-knight>) from the original on 30 June 2017. Retrieved 27 June 2017.

37. "Hollow Knight for Nintendo Switch Reviews" (<https://www.metacritic.com/game/hollow-knight/critic-reviews/?platform=nintendo-switch>). *Metacritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180629053147/http://www.metacritic.com/game/switch/hollow-knight>) from the original on June 29, 2018. Retrieved June 27, 2018.
38. "Hollow Knight: Voidheart Edition for PlayStation 4 Reviews" (<https://www.metacritic.com/game/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition/critic-reviews/?platform=playstation-4>). *Metacritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200705152832/https://www.metacritic.com/game/playstation-4/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition>) from the original on 5 July 2020. Retrieved 26 April 2020.
39. "Hollow Knight: Voidheart Edition for Xbox One Reviews" (<https://www.metacritic.com/game/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition/critic-reviews/?platform=xbox-one>). *Metacritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200612074315/https://www.metacritic.com/game/xbox-one/hollow-knight-voidheart-edition>) from the original on 12 June 2020. Retrieved 26 April 2020.
40. "Hollow Knight Reviews" (<https://openritic.com/game/4002/hollow-knight>). *OpenCritic*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250506042311/https://openritic.com/game/4002/hollow-knight>) from the original on 6 May 2025. Retrieved 20 May 2025.
41. Blake, Vikki (28 June 2018). "Hollow Knight review – a slick, stylish, and super tough Metroidvania" (<https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2018-06-28-hollow-knight-a-slick-stylish-and-super-tough-metroidvania>). *Eurogamer.net*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180628100442/https://www.eurogamer.net/articles/2018-06-28-hollow-knight-a-slick-stylish-and-super-tough-metroidvania>) from the original on 28 June 2018. Retrieved 28 June 2018.
42. Marks, Tom (21 June 2018). "Hollow Knight Review" (<https://uk.ign.com/articles/2018/06/22/hollow-knight-review>). *IGN*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190913213126/https://uk.ign.com/articles/2018/06/22/hollow-knight-review>) from the original on 13 September 2019. Retrieved 22 June 2018.
43. Mundy, Jon (19 June 2018). "Review: Hollow Knight (Switch eShop)" (https://www.nintendolife.com/reviews/switch-eshop/hollow_knight). *Nintendo Life*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180622045423/http://www.nintendolife.com/reviews/switch-eshop/hollow_knight) from the original on 22 June 2018. Retrieved 22 June 2018.
44. Abou-Nasr, Adam (22 June 2018). "Hollow Knight Review – Review" (<http://www.nintendoworldreport.com/review/47609/hollow-knight-switch-review>). *Nintendo World Report*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180624150332/http://www.nintendoworldreport.com/review/47609/hollow-knight-switch-review>) from the original on 24 June 2018. Retrieved 24 June 2018.
45. Forrest, Tavish (15 May 2017). "Review: Hollow Knight" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180623141342/https://www.pcpowerplay.com.au/review/hollow-knight,461771>). *PC PowerPlay Magazine*. Archived from the original (<https://www.pcpowerplay.com.au/review/hollow-knight,461771>) on 23 June 2018. Retrieved 23 June 2018.
46. Cook, Adam (27 June 2018). "Hollow Knight review" (<https://www.videogamer.com/reviews/hollow-knight-review>). *VideoGamer.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180628015909/https://www.videogamer.com/reviews/hollow-knight-review>) from the original on 28 June 2018. Retrieved 27 June 2018.
47. Walker, Alex (10 November 2017). "Hollow Knight Has Sold Over 500,000 Copies" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171110115410/https://www.kotaku.com.au/2017/11/hollow-knight-has-sold-over-500000-copies/>). *Kotaku*. Archived from the original (<https://www.kotaku.com.au/2017/11/hollow-knight-has-sold-over-500000-copies/>) on 10 November 2017. Retrieved 10 November 2017.
48. Walker, Alex (5 July 2018). "Hollow Knight Has Sold More Than 1 Million Copies On PC" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180724032155/https://www.kotaku.com.au/2018/07/hollow-knight-has-sold-more-than-1-million-copies-on-pc/>). *Kotaku Australia*. Archived from the original (<https://www.kotaku.com.au/2018/07/hollow-knight-has-sold-more-than-1-million-copies-on-pc/>) on 24 July 2018. Retrieved 23 July 2018.

49. Stevens, Colin (29 June 2018). "Hollow Knight Sold over 250,000 Copies on Switch in Its First Two Weeks" (<https://uk.ign.com/articles/2018/06/29/hollow-knight-sold-over-250000-copies-on-switch-in-its-first-two-weeks>). *IGN*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190913202828/https://uk.ign.com/articles/2018/06/29/hollow-knight-sold-over-250000-copies-on-switch-in-its-first-two-weeks>) from the original on 13 September 2019. Retrieved 29 June 2018.
50. Gibson, Ari (14 February 2019). "Hollow Knight: Silksong Revealed!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190310231829/http://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-silksong/>). *Team Cherry*. Archived from the original (<https://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-silksong/>) on 10 March 2019.
51. Walker, Alex (15 February 2019). "Hollow Knight Has Sold over 2.8 Million Copies" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190215060104/https://www.kotaku.com.au/2019/02/hollow-knight-has-sold-over-2-8-million-copies/>). Archived from the original (<https://www.kotaku.com.au/2019/02/hollow-knight-has-sold-over-2-8-million-copies/>) on 15 February 2019.
52. Schreier, Jason (21 August 2025). "Why 'Silksong' Took Seven Years to Make" (<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/newsletters/2025-08-21/why-silksong-team-cherry-s-sequel-to-hollow-knight-took-so-long-to-make>). *Bloomberg*. Retrieved 21 August 2025.
53. Carter, Chris (12 December 2017). "Nominees for Destructoid's Best PC Game of 2017" (<https://www.destructoid.com/nominees-for-destructoid-s-best-pc-game-of-2017-476291.phtml>). *Destructoid*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171213041643/https://www.destructoid.com/nominees-for-destructoid-s-best-pc-game-of-2017-476291.phtml>) from the original on 13 December 2017. Retrieved 3 January 2018.
54. "Best of 2017 Awards: Best Platformer" (https://www.ign.com/wikis/best-of-2017-awards/Best_Platformer). *IGN*. 20 December 2017. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20171231213750/http://www.ign.com/wikis/best-of-2017-awards/Best_Platformer) from the original on 31 December 2017. Retrieved 3 January 2018.
55. PC Gamer staff (17 December 2017). "Best Platformer 2017: Hollow Knight" (<https://www.pcgamer.com/best-platformer-2017-hollow-knight/>). *PC Gamer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171229223557/http://www.pcgamer.com/best-platformer-2017-hollow-knight/>) from the original on 29 December 2017. Retrieved 31 December 2017.
56. "The 100 best games of the decade (2010–2019): 100–51" (<https://www.polygon.com/features/2019/11/4/20944265/best-games-2019-2010-ps4-switch-xbox-pc-100-51>). *Polygon*. November 4, 2019. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20191110011916/https://www.polygon.com/features/2019/11/4/20944265/best-games-2019-2010-ps4-switch-xbox-pc-100-51>) from the original on November 10, 2019. Retrieved November 9, 2019.
57. Aviles, Estevan (31 January 2017). "Gamer's Voice Nominees Revealed for SXSW Gaming 2017" (<https://gaming.sxsw.com/news/2017/gamers-voice-nominees-revealed-sxsw-gaming-2017/>). *SXSW*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180220151954/https://gaming.sxsw.com/news/2017/gamers-voice-nominees-revealed-sxsw-gaming-2017/>) from the original on 20 February 2018. Retrieved 16 March 2018.
58. Makuch, Eddie (8 December 2017). "The Game Awards 2017 Winners Headlined By Zelda: Breath Of The Wild's Game Of The Year" (<https://www.gamespot.com/articles/the-game-awards-2017-winners-headlined-by-zelda-br/1100-6455467/>). *GameSpot*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171209043912/https://www.gamespot.com/articles/the-game-awards-2017-winners-headlined-by-zelda-br/1100-6455467/>) from the original on 9 December 2017. Retrieved 31 December 2017.
59. "The 2017 ASSG Award Winners" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220520162913/https://assg.org.au/the-2017-assg-award-winners/>). *Australian Screen Sound Guild*. 26 November 2017. Archived from the original (<https://assg.org.au/the-2017-assg-award-winners/>) on 20 May 2022. Retrieved 9 May 2022.

60. Gamasutra staff (5 January 2018). "Breath of the Wild & Horizon Zero Dawn lead GDC 2018 Choice Awards nominees!" (https://archive.today/20180108234223/https://www.gamasutra.com/view/news/312569/Breath_of_the_Wild_Horizon_Zero_Dawn_lead_GDC_2018_Choice_Awards_nominees.php). *Gamasutra*. Archived from the original (https://www.gamasutra.com/view/news/312569/Breath_of_the_Wild_Horizon_Zero_Dawn_lead_GDC_2018_Choice_Awards_nominees.php) on 8 January 2018. Retrieved 8 January 2018.
61. Makuch, Eddie (22 March 2018). "Legend Of Zelda: Breath Of The Wild Wins Another Game Of The Year Award" (<https://www.gamespot.com/articles/legend-of-zelda-breath-of-the-wild-wins-another-ga/1100-6457600/>). *GameSpot*. Archived (<https://archive.today/20180324205030/https://www.gamespot.com/articles/legend-of-zelda-breath-of-the-wild-wins-another-ga/1100-6457600/>) from the original on 24 March 2018. Retrieved 22 March 2018.
62. deAlessandri, Marie (15 March 2018). "Hellblade: Senua's Sacrifice at forefront of BAFTA Games Awards nominations" (<https://www.mcvuk.com/business/hellblade-senuas-sacrifice-at-forefront-of-bafta-games-awards-nominations>). *MCV*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180316161255/https://www.mcvuk.com/business/hellblade-senuas-sacrifice-at-forefront-of-bafta-games-awards-nominations>) from the original on 16 March 2018. Retrieved 16 March 2018.
63. Makedonski, Brett (12 April 2018). "BAFTA names What Remains of Edith Finch its best game of 2017" (<https://www.destructoid.com/bafta-names-what-remains-of-edith-finch-its-best-game-of-2017-498392.phtml>). *Destructoid*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180425185417/https://www.destructoid.com/bafta-names-what-remains-of-edith-finch-its-best-game-of-2017-498392.phtml>) from the original on 25 April 2018. Retrieved 13 April 2018.
64. Hoggins, Tom (24 September 2018). "Golden Joysticks 2018 nominees announced, voting open now" (<https://www.telegraph.co.uk/gaming/news/golden-joysticks-2018-nominees-announced-voting-open-now/>). *The Daily Telegraph*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20181011022740/https://www.telegraph.co.uk/gaming/news/golden-joysticks-2018-nominees-announced-voting-open-now/>) from the original on 11 October 2018. Retrieved 7 October 2018.
65. Sheridan, Connor (16 November 2018). "Golden Joystick Awards 2018 winners: God of War wins big but Fortnite gets Victory Royale" (<https://www.gamesradar.com/golden-joystick-awards-2018-winners/>). *GamesRadar+*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20181116213338/https://www.gamesradar.com/golden-joystick-awards-2018-winners/>) from the original on 16 November 2018. Retrieved 18 November 2018.
66. Grixti, Shannon (20 December 2018). "All the winners from the Australian Games Awards" (<https://press-start.com.au/news/2018/12/20/all-the-winners-from-the-australian-games-awards/>). *Press-Start*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20181220230409/https://press-start.com.au/news/2018/12/20/all-the-winners-from-the-australian-games-awards/>) from the original on 20 December 2018. Retrieved 20 December 2018.
67. "Nominee List for 2018" (<https://navgtr.org/2019/02/11/nominee-list-for-2018/>). National Academy of Video Game Trade Reviewers. 11 February 2019. Archived (<https://archive.today/20190213220549/http://navgtr.org/archives/3566/>) from the original on 13 February 2019. Retrieved 21 June 2020.
68. "2018 Awards" (<https://archive.today/20190314083147/http://navgtr.org/archives/3601/>). National Academy of Video Game Trade Reviewers. 13 March 2019. Archived from the original (<https://navgtr.org/2018-awards/>) on 14 March 2019. Retrieved 21 June 2020.
69. Goslin, Austen (16 September 2022). "Hollow Knight: Silksong is coming to PlayStation, too" (<https://www.polygon.com/23356651/hollow-knight-silksong-ps4-ps5-playstation-release-date>). *Polygon*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20250430050801/https://www.polygon.com/23356651/hollow-knight-silksong-ps4-ps5-playstation-release-date>) from the original on 30 April 2025. Retrieved 30 April 2025.

70. Souppouris, Aaron (13 February 2019). "'Silksong' is a full-blown sequel to 'Hollow Knight' " (<https://www.engadget.com/2019/02/14/hollow-knight-silksong-trailer/>). *engadget*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190214152956/https://www.engadget.com/2019/02/14/hollow-knight-silksong-trailer/>) from the original on 14 February 2019. Retrieved 13 February 2019.
71. Colp, Tyler (10 February 2022). "Hollow Knight: Silksong—Everything we know about the upcoming sequel" (<https://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knight-silksong-everything-we-know/>). *PC Gamer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220210224506/https://www.pcgamer.com/hollow-knight-silksong-everything-we-know/>) from the original on 10 February 2022. Retrieved 11 May 2022.
72. "Differences and New Features - Hollow Knight: Silksong Guide" (https://www.ign.com/wikis/hollow-knight-silksong/Differences_and_New_Features). *IGN*. 3 September 2025. Retrieved 6 September 2025.
73. Team Cherry (14 February 2019). "'Hollow Knight: Silksong' Revealed!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190310231829/http://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-silksong/>). Archived from the original (<https://teamcherry.com.au/hollow-knight-silksong/>) on 10 March 2019. Retrieved 11 March 2019.

External links

- [Official website \(https://hollowknight.com\)](https://hollowknight.com) 
-

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Hollow_Knight&oldid=1310336996"